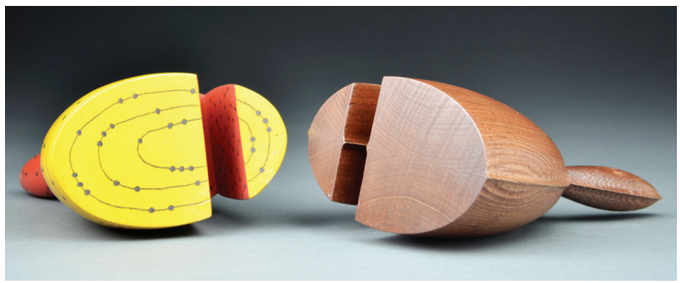
Kimberly Winkle –'Binary'

Kimberly Winkle's piece for the AAW's Creativity in Construction: A Collaboration of Materials

PHOTOGRAPHS BY KIMBERLY WINKLE

'Binary', walnut (*Juglans regia*), polychrome poplar (*Populus spp.*), 150 x 125 x 95mm, individually

'Binary' was created for the AAW's POP invitational show entitled 'Creativity in Construction: A Collaboration of Materials', which was exhibited at the AAW headquarters in Minnesota and subsequently at the AAW International symposium in Pittsburgh, PA. In the creation of 'Binary', I had in mind a collaboration of not only materials – wood and paint – but also a collaboration of processes, traditional techniques and new technologies. As a result, 'Binary' was inspired largely by the confluence of modes of making; in this case, digital and traditional. The original form was modelled using a CAD program called Rhino and subsequently, carved from a solid block of walnut (*Juglans regia*) using a CNC router. While the CNC efficiently translates the CAD rendered image, the technology's limitations are also revealed in the process and outcome. For example, the rounded corners of the interior void, apparent exterior seams and the textured surface left behind from the cutting burr. Admittedly, I find none of these aspects bothersome but, in response, I reproduced the CAD form in poplar (*Populus spp.*) using traditional analogue techniques of lathe turning, carving and painting. This allowed for increased hands-on control, more attention to detail and improvisation of surface and colour. In the end, the collaboration of techniques results in a duet of forms that simultaneously look forward while also celebrating tradition; creating an interesting dialogue between the two.



The undersides of 'Binary'

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